

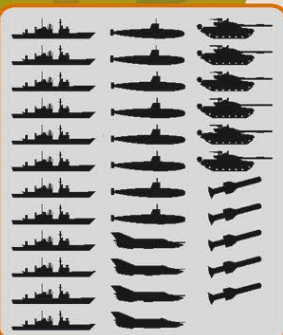
A FEW COUNTRIES, SUCH AS
LIECHTENSTEIN AND COSTA RICA,
HAVE NO MILITARY FORCES

USA
The USA spends almost \$934 billion per year on its armed forces—more than the next seven-biggest spending countries added together.

KEY

The total amount of military expenditure by all the countries of the world in 2010 was \$1.83 trillion, which is equivalent to \$235 for every person on the planet—almost double what was spent per capita in 2001. The map shows the total number of military vehicles, hardware, and weapons held by selected major countries.

-  Up to 10 large warships (including aircraft carriers, cruisers, destroyers, frigates, and corvettes)
-  Up to 10 submarines
-  Up to 500 combat-capable aircraft
-  Up to 1,000 main battle tanks
-  Up to 500 nuclear warheads



Brazil
Brazil's armed forces are the largest in South America. The army takes an active role in education, health care, and the construction of roads and railroads.

France
France holds the world's third-largest nuclear arsenal, with 300 active warheads.



Israel
All Israeli men and women must serve for 2 to 3 years in their armed forces. Israel is the only country to make service for women mandatory.



Egypt
All Egyptian men between 18 and 30 must serve in the army for 1 to 3 years.

UK
In 2010, the UK spent \$56 billion on its armed forces, making it the world's fifth-biggest military spender.



Armed forces

Almost all countries have a military—an organized force of soldiers and weapons that defends the country against threats from outside or within. Many countries believe that a large, well-equipped military will discourage others from attacking.

Sky-high warfare

Armed forces are increasingly using unmanned drones for surveillance or to launch missiles. Drones are controlled remotely from the ground, so air crew is not risked during missions.

